

GOODALL, JANE



FROM 1960 TO 1995, Jane Goodall spent 35 remarkable years devoted to studying chimpanzees in the wild, and became one of the world's most respected and influential zoologists. She began her painstaking research alone in the middle of the tropical forest in Tanzania, East Africa, and steadily built up one of the foremost centres for field research on primates. Her observations and those of her colleagues revolutionized our knowledge of chimpanzee behaviour and shed light on our own human ancestry.



Goodall with one of the chimps at Gombe

Research

In spite of Jane Goodall's lack of formal training, Louis Leakey decided to help her realize her dream. In 1960, he raised funds for her to begin a research programme at Gombe, Tanzania. She has been based there ever since. In the 1960s, most primatologists studied captive animals in zoos. Goodall's task was different – to gain the confidence of the chimps and study them at close quarters in their natural environment.

Communication

Goodall was fascinated by the way the chimps used sounds, gestures, and expressions to communicate with each other. Every noise conveyed a different message, and gestures and body movements were also forms of communication.

Displays

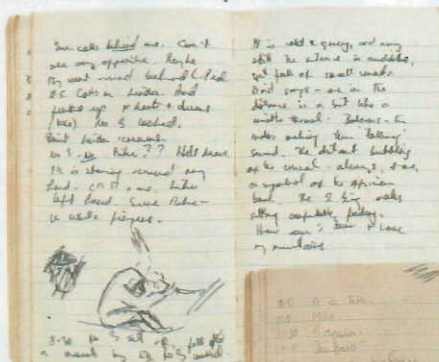
Goodall saw how body movements act as visual displays of emotion and intent. Males issue threats to rivals by charging forward with their fur raised, often dragging branches or throwing stones. Early on, Goodall noted that groups of chimps would react to coming rainfall with an agitated "rain dance".

Charging display



Touch

Goodall observed that chimps would often pat, embrace, or kiss as a way of calming distressed individuals. She also saw them grooming each other's fur. This has a calming effect and strengthens social bonds.



In her lonely observation posts in the jungle, Goodall made careful drawings of the chimps' use of tools and other behaviour.

Two of Goodall's notebooks

Conservation

Goodall championed the cause of chimpanzee conservation and campaigned for better conditions for captive chimps. In 1977, she launched the Jane Goodall Institute for Wildlife Research, Education, and Conservation in the USA. By the late 1990s, it had branches in the UK, Canada, and Tanzania.



Goodall campaigning for chimpanzees

Early life

Jane Goodall was born in London, England, in 1934. As a teenager she dreamed of studying wildlife in Africa, and the ambition never faded. In 1957, with savings from a summer job as a waitress, she embarked on a trip to Kenya. There she approached the famous anthropologist Louis Leakey, and told him she wanted to work in Africa. Leakey gave her a job as a secretary.



Working methods

Goodall worked by spending day after day alone in the forest with the chimpanzees. Gradually, she won their confidence and they accepted her. She filled her notebooks with descriptions of the chimpanzees, and wrote freely of the emotions, personalities, and intelligence of the chimps.

Toolmaking

One of Goodall's most startling discoveries was that wild chimps are good toolmakers. They use objects as tools, modifying them to suit their purpose. She saw chimps stripping twigs to make probes for "fishing" termites from their nests, and chewing clumps of leaves to make sponges for getting water from shallow pools.

JANE GOODALL

- 1934 Born in London, England.
- 1957 Travels to Kenya and meets Louis Leakey.
- 1960 Establishes research station at Gombe, Tanzania.
- 1965 Gains doctorate from Cambridge University.
- 1971 Publishes *In the Shadow of Man*, first of several influential books.
- 1977 Founds Jane Goodall Institute.
- 1991 Launches international youth environmental programme, "Roots and Shoots".
- 1995 Receives Hubbard Medal.

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